also knelt while enquiring about Babur's welfare and then again when he offered the tribute. He repeated the same with Jahāngīr Mīrzā and Wais Mīrzā Khān.

Babur has described the incident as follows:[*]

> That sluggish old manikin who through so many years had just pleased himself, lacking sovereignty one thing only, namely, to read the Khuṭba in his name, now knelt twenty-five or twenty-six times in succession, and came and went till he was so wearied out that he tottered forward. His many years of begship and authority vanished from his view.

After the formalities and accepting gifts from Khusrau Shāh, Babur got him seated suitably. They stayed in that place for a couple of *garīs*,[†] recounting some tales and talking about wellbeing. According to Babur, Khusrau Shāh's conversations were insipid and empty. Babur felt that the reason behind this was Khusrau Shāh's cowardice and the fact that he was false to his salt. However, Khusrau Shāh was noticeably disturbed, perhaps because all his trusted retainers had gone under Babur's service. Such was the agony of Khusrau Shāh's affairs that he, the sovereign-aping manikin, had to come, willy-nilly, abased and without any honour, to a sort of interview he would have never wished for.

In a display of high moral ground, Babur consoled Khusrau Shāh. The latter replied, 'Those very servants have four times left me and returned.'

Babur asked Khusrau Shāh at what point his brother Walī would cross the Amū and when exactly he would arrive. Khusraw replied, 'If he finds a ford, he will soon be here, but when waters rise, fords change; the (Persian) proverb has it, "The waters have carried down the fords".'

About this response, *Baburnama* mentioned, 'These words Allah brought to his tongue in that hour of the flowing away of his own authority and following.'

After being seated there for almost an hour, Babur rode back to his camp and Khusrau Shāh returned to his. The latter's bad time had begun, and Babur's stars had begun to shine. After Khusrau Shāh returned, his begs with their servants and several tribes began to desert him. They had begun to come and join Babur along with their families. By the afternoon, of the day he returned, not a man remained in his service.

For this instance, Babur has cited the Qur'an:[*]

> Say, —O God! who possessest the kingdom! Thou givest it to whom Thou wilt and Thou takest it from whom Thou wilt! In Thy hand is good, for Thou art almighty.[3]

Babur has hailed Allah for his power, for having seen the turning of fate. Khusrau Shāh was once a master of around 30,000 retainers. Once upon a time